Console Skin Replication – Step-by-Step Documentation

Page 1: Overview & Workflow Introduction

Purpose of This Document

This documentation explains the **end-to-end process for replicating skin vinyl designs for gaming consoles** (PS5, PS4, PS4 Pro, controllers, handheld consoles, etc.). It is intended for **replicators** who receive creative files and are responsible for laying out designs, preparing mockups, and exporting assets accurately and consistently.

The goal is to ensure: - Design accuracy across all console types - Consistent placement of critical assets (logos, crests, legal lines) - Correct sequencing of designs based on Creative's tracker - Error-free automation using Photoshop scripts and actions

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High-Level Workflow

1. Receive creative email with raw PSD link and design tracker
2. Download and review provided assets
3. Layout designs across all console PSDs using Smart Objects
4. Organize design groups and validate sequencing
5. Prepare Photoshop scripts and actions
6. Run automation to export mockups
7. Save outputs in designated folders by design code

Roles & Responsibilities

Creative Team - Provides raw PSD files (e.g., PS5, PS4, controllers) - Supplies design guide and placement rules - Shares Google Sheet tracker with design codes and sequence

Replication Team - Lays out designs across all required console templates - Ensures compliance with the design guide - Prepares and runs Photoshop automation - Exports and organizes final mockups

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Page 2: Receiving & Reviewing Creative Files

Visual Reference: Creative DOs & DON'Ts

Refer to the **Sports General Guideline – DOs and DON'Ts** image provided by Creative.

DOs - Follow approved placement for patterns and logos - Keep important assets centered within safe zones - Maintain visual balance across console panels

DON'Ts - Do not place logos across panel breaks - Do not distort crests or stretch artwork - Avoid placing legal lines near cut edges

These rules apply to all consoles and controllers unless otherwise stated.

Step 1: Email Intake from Creative

The process begins when the Creative Team sends an email containing: - A **download link** to the raw PSD file(s) - A **design guide** outlining asset placement rules - A **Google Sheet tracker link** listing: - Design codes - Design names - Required console types - Design sequence/order

> ⚠️ Always confirm that all links are accessible before starting work.

Step 2: Download & Folder Setup

Create a local project folder using the following structure:

- Project_Name
  - 01_Raw_PSD
  - 02_Working_PSD
  - 03_Scripts_Actions
  - 04_Mockups_Output
    - Design_Code_001
    - Design_Code_002

This structure ensures clean automation and prevents file overwrite issues.

Step 3: Review the Design Guide

Before opening Photoshop: - Read the design guide fully - Cross-check DOs and DON'Ts visuals - Identify **safe zones**, **cut lines**, and **bleed areas** - Note placement rules for: - Logos - Crests - Legal lines

The provided visual examples should be treated as **non-negotiable reference standards**. Before opening Photoshop: - Read the design guide fully - Identify **safe zones** and **restricted areas** - Note placement rules for: - Logos - Crests - Legal lines - Edge bleed and cut lines

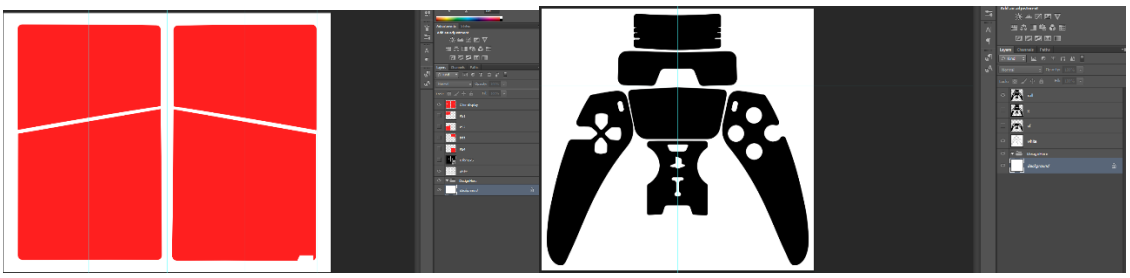
This guide applies across all console types unless stated otherwise.

Page 3: Design Layout Using PSD & Smart Objects

Step 4: Open Console PSD Files

Each console type (PS5, PS4, PS4 Pro, controller, handheld) has its own PSD file containing: - Pre-built templates - Smart Objects for artwork placement - Masked areas matching vinyl cut shapes

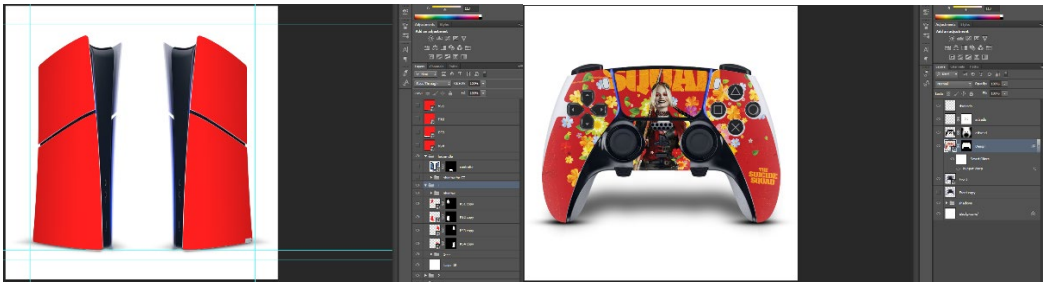
Always work from **duplicated PSDs** stored in the `02_Working_PSD` folder.



Step 5: Using Smart Objects

Inside each PSD: - Locate the Smart Object layer for artwork - Double-click to open the Smart Object - Paste or place the design artwork - Scale and position according to the design guide - Save and close the Smart Object to apply changes

> ✅ Never rasterize or flatten Smart Objects.



Step 6: Managing Design Groups

Each PSD must contain: - **3–5 or more designs** per file - Each design placed inside its own **group folder**

Group naming convention example: - 001_MIRACULOUS_LAD - 002_MIRACULOUS_CAT - 003_MIRACULOUS_HPA

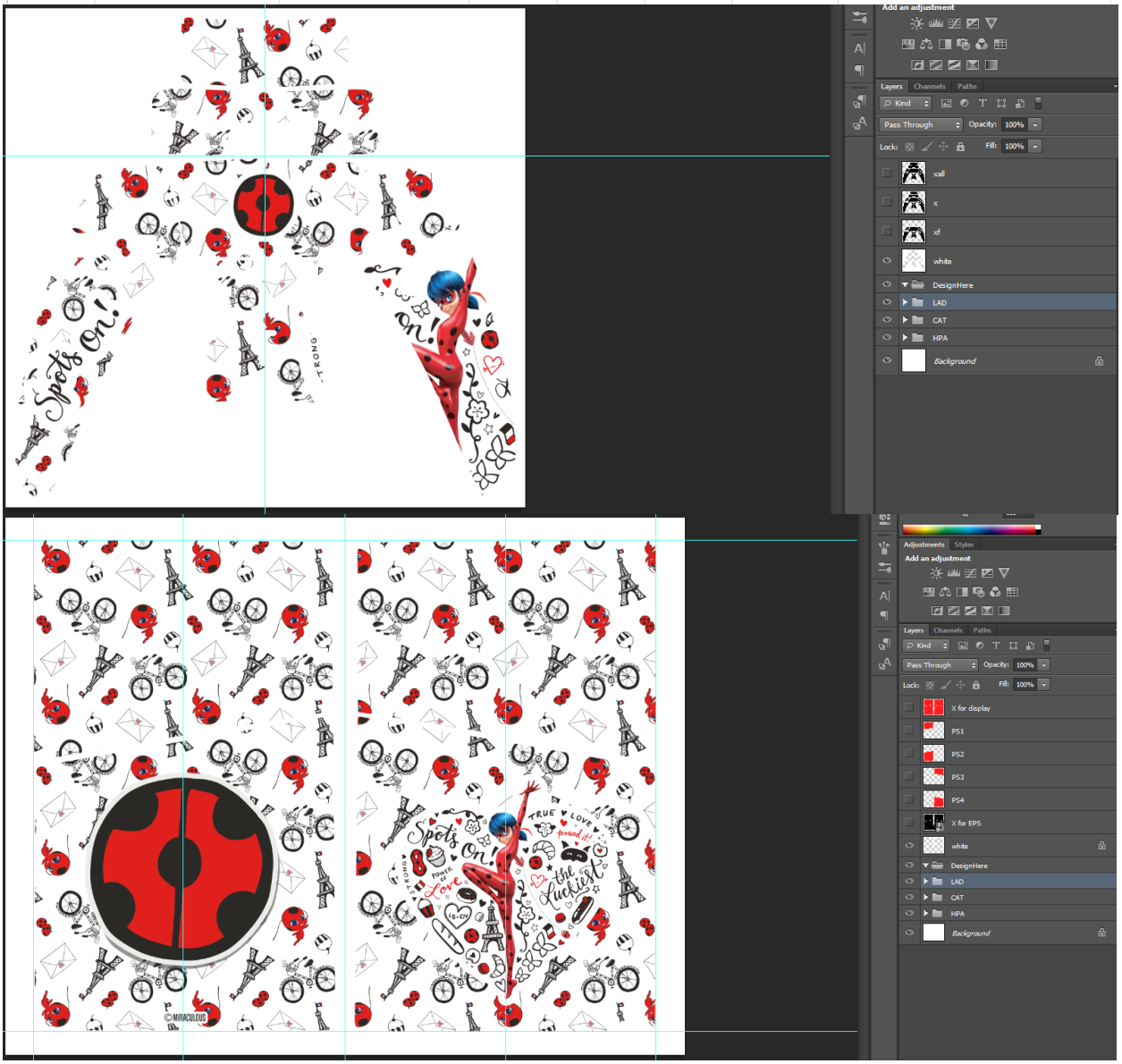
The **order of groups must match the Google Sheet tracker exactly**.

> Visual reference: See *PSD with design sample for console/controller* screenshots for correct layer structure. Each PSD must contain: - **3–5 or more designs** - Each design placed inside its own **group folder**

Group naming convention example: - 001_DesignCode_Name - 002_DesignCode_Name - 003_DesignCode_Name

The **order of groups must match the Google Sheet tracker exactly**.

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
GAME CONSOLE SKIN							
Batch	Lineup Names	Design Name	Designer	Colors	Family Code	Design Code	Final Custom Label
	Key Art	Ladybug			MIRAKEY	LAD	H8939-PS4PRO-MIRAKEY-LAD
		Power Of Creation			MIRAKEY	POW	H8939-PS4PRO-MIRAKEY-POW
		Ladybug And Cat Noir			MIRAKEY	LAC	H8939-PS4PRO-MIRAKEY-LAC
1	Character Art And Patterns	Ladybug			MIRACAR	LAD	H8939-PS4PRO-MIRACAR-LAD
		Cat Noir			MIRACAR	CAT	H8939-PS4PRO-MIRACAR-CAT
		Heroes			MIRACAR	HPA	H8939-PS4PRO-MIRACAR-HPA



Step 7: Cross-Console Consistency

Repeat the same design placement across: - PS5 - PS4 / PS4 Pro - Controllers - Handheld consoles

Ensure: - Logos stay within allowed zones - Legal lines remain readable - No important asset crosses cut lines

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Page 4: Preparing Photoshop Scripts & Actions

Step 8: Verify Design Codes

Before automation: - Compare PSD group names with the tracker - Confirm: - Design codes match exactly - Sequence/order is correct - No missing or extra designs

Automation depends entirely on correct naming.

Step 9: Preparing Photoshop Actions

Actions should: - Toggle visibility per design group - Apply required adjustments (if any) - Trigger mockup generation steps

Best practices: - One master action per console type - Avoid manual pauses in actions - Test actions on a single design first

> Visual reference: See *Script Sample* screenshot for action and script alignment. Actions should: - Toggle visibility per design group - Apply required adjustments (if any) - Trigger mockup generation steps

Best practices: - One master action per console type - Avoid manual pauses in actions - Test actions on a single design first

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Step 10: Preparing Photoshop Scripts

Scripts are used to: - Loop through design groups - Read design codes - Save mockups automatically - Route outputs to correct folders

Key script elements (based on provided sample): - Defined input and output paths - Design code array matching PSD groups - Automated save logic per design

Ensure scripts: - Match the design group naming exactly - Use the same design code format as the PSD and tracker - Point to the correct output directories

> Any mismatch between script, PSD, and Google Sheet will cause export errors. Scripts are used to: - Loop through design groups - Read design codes - Save mockups automatically - Route outputs to correct folders

Ensure scripts: - Match the design group naming - Use the same design code format as the PSD - Point to the correct output directories

Adobe Photoshop CS6 (64 bit) (60.064)

```
#target photoshop

psdPath='C:/NICA/NEW SKIN 4/PSD/';
savePath =  'C:/NICA/NEW SKIN 4/Output/';
assetPath = 'C:/NICA/NEW SKIN 4/Assets/';

//_____________________________________________________________________________________________________//

standard = true;

var records = {

miracar:{_lineup:"MIRACAR",_lineuplabel:"MIRACAR",_designlabels:"LAD_0|CAT_0|HPA_0"},

//-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
};


var dialog = new Window('dialog', 'Alert Box Builder', [100, 100, 580, 495]);
dialog.nygel = dialog.add('panel', [25, 25, 450, 380], 'Input links: ');
dialog.nygel.urls = dialog.nygel.add('edittext', [15, 15, 405, 290], '', {
    multiline: true
});
//dialog.nygel.urls.value = true;
dialog.nygel.buildBtn = dialog.nygel.add('button', [170, 300, 250, 325], 'OK', {
    name: 'ok'
});
dialog.show();
var inputText = dialog.nygel.urls.text;
var inputArray = inputText.split("\n");
templen = inputArray.length - 1;
if (inputArray[templen] == "") {
    inputArray.pop();
}
preferences.rulerUnits = Units.PIXELS;
cTID = function(s) {
    return app.charIDToTypeID(s);
};
sTID = function(s) {
    return app.stringIDToTypeID(s);
};
for (lpr = 0; lpr < inputArray.length; lpr++) {
    var LU = inputArray[lpr];
    LU = LU.replace(/ /g, "");
    LU = LU.replace(/-/g, "");
```

Page 5: Running Automation & Exporting Mockups

Step 11: Test Run

Before full export: - Run the script on **one design only** - Verify: - Correct mockup is generated - File naming is accurate - Output folder is correct

Fix any errors before proceeding.

Step 12: Full Script Execution

Once validated: - Run the script for all designs - Monitor Photoshop for errors - Avoid using Photoshop during execution

Exported mockups will be saved automatically into: - 04_Mockups_Output > Design_Code folders

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Step 13: Final Quality Check

After export: - Spot-check random mockups - Confirm: - Correct design on correct console - No missing assets - Proper alignment and scaling

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Step 14: Completion & Handoff

Once verified: - Notify the Creative or Production team - Share output folder location - Report any issues or deviations

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Notes & Best Practices

- Always follow the Creative design guide first
- Never rename layers mid-process without updating scripts
- Keep backups before running automation
- Consistency = speed + accuracy

End of Documentation